

Date	2024-03-14	Time	09:00–17:00
Location	Board Room, Lyon Head Office	Ref.	CRI-STRAT-2024-002
Chair	Mr François Lemercier, CEO	Secretary	Ms Hélène Marchand, Operations Director

ATTENDEES

Name	Role / Department	Attendance
Mr François Lemercier	Executive Management	Present
Ms Hélène Marchand	Operations / COO	Present
Dr. Martine Chabrol	R&D / CTO	Present
Mr Pierre Valentin	Sales Management	Present
Mr Thierry Bruneau	Finance / CFO	Present
Ms Ingrid Hoffmann	QHSE & Regulatory	Present
Mr Jacques Delorme	Independent Director (guest)	Present (morning)

AGENDA

- 2023 performance review and Q1 2024 outlook
- Product portfolio analysis — BCG and ROI by segment
- Presentation of the "Green chemistry" strategic pillar — BioSolv and GreenCat projects
- 2025-2027 investment plan — prioritisation
- International expansion — Maghreb and Benelux markets
- Regulatory risks 2024-2025 (REACH SVHCs, F-gas)
- Closing remarks and decisions

PROCEEDINGS

1. 2023 performance review

Mr Bruneau presented the 2023 consolidated accounts (provisional): revenue €47.2M (+6.3% vs 2022), EBITDA €8.4M (margin 17.8%, target 18.5%). The margin shortfall is mainly explained by the rise in energy costs (+31% vs 2022) only partly passed through in prices (+9% on average), and by the BioSolv-3 R&D investment (€380k not originally budgeted).

Net income: €4.1M (+2.8% vs 2022). Positive net cash: €6.2M. Debt/EBITDA ratio: 1.4× (target below 2×). The financial position is sound enough to absorb the 2025-2027 investment plan.

By segment: industrial solvents 38% of revenue (+4%), inorganic acids and bases 28% (+8%), chemical specialties 21% (+12%), trading 13% (-2%). Specialties (margins above 30%) are the priority growth area.

2. Portfolio analysis — BCG

Dr. Chabrol presented the BCG analysis of the portfolio (41 active references): Stars (growth above 10%, relative share above 1): 6 products (including USP propylene glycol, refined glycerol, pilot bio-based formulations). Cash cows (growth below 5%, share above 1): 12 products — standard chlorinated solvents and mineral acids. Cash generators

requiring little investment. Question marks (growth above 10%, share below 1): 9 products — new catalysts, pharma specialities. Dogs (growth below 5%, share below 1): 14 products, candidates for progressive discontinuation.

Mr Lemerrier decided to launch a valuation analysis of the 14 "dogs" with the option of divestment or discontinuation.

Mr Valentin and Mr Bruneau were mandated to present options in June 2024.

3. Green chemistry strategic pillar

Dr. Chabrol presented the ChemCorp Green Chemistry roadmap for 2025-2030: Pillar 1 — Bio-based: extension of the BioSolv range (target of 8 references by 2026), a partnership under way with a Burgundy agricultural cooperative for biomass supply. Pillar 2 — Green processes: the GreenCat project (heterogeneous catalysis to cut energy consumption by 25% on esterification reactions), partial ANR funding requested. Pillar 3 — Circular economy: recovery and valorisation of customers' used solvents (a regeneration service), business model under study.

Mr Delorme (director) questioned the ability to certify bio-based origin: Dr. Chabrol confirmed that the partnership with Bureau Veritas for ISCC+ certification is under negotiation, with completion expected in September 2024.

Mr Bruneau presented the Green Chemistry business plan: total investment €2.8M over 3 years, expected 5-year ROI: 18%. Funding: 40% equity, 30% bank debt, 30% grants (ADEME, BPI France — applications in preparation).

4. 2025-2027 investment plan

Ms Marchand presented the consolidated 2025-2027 capex plan: total €7.4M over 3 years. Priority 1 — Safety and regulatory compliance: €1.8M (SEVESO upgrades, effluent treatment modernisation). Priority 2 — Bio-based solvent capacity expansion: €2.2M (a new 5,000 L reactor and a dedicated distillation unit). Priority 3 — Digitalisation and automation: €1.4M (MES, LIMS, packaging automation). Priority 4 — R&D (equipment): €2.0M (NMR spectrometer, GC-MS/MS chromatograph, high-pressure autoclave reactor 100 mL×8).

Minutes CRI-STRAT-2024-002 — Action plan

ACTION PLAN

Owner	Action to be taken	Due date
Mr Valentin + Mr Bruneau	Present valuation/divestment options for the 14 'dog' products	2024-06-30
Dr. Chabrol	Finalise the ANR GreenCat application + the ADEME BioSolv application	2024-04-30
Ms Marchand	Launch capex tenders for Priority 1 (safety/regulatory)	2024-04-30
Mr Bruneau	Build the funding application for BPI France and partner banks	2024-05-31
Ms Hoffmann	Present the SEVESO tier 2 compliance plan (if applicable)	2024-04-30

Next meeting: Next Strategy Committee: 12 September 2024

These minutes will be deemed approved unless written comments are received within 5 working days of circulation.